Lab 37: A shared slash command still needs -p in CI

Topic 3: Claude Code Configuration & Workflows · Task 3.6: Integrate Claude Code into CI/CD pipelines

Runs on Simulator 5: Claude Code for Continuous Integration · Self-practice

Source: SkillCertPro practice exam Part 1, Q38 (unofficial third-party question)

The question

A nightly pull request check for this team invokes Claude Code to inspect changes to refund and escalation logic. In CI, the job prints the prompt and then waits until the runner times out because there is no terminal user to answer follow-up prompts. What change best prevents this failure mode?

A. Run Claude Code in plan mode and require the job to approve the generated plan automatically.

B. Create a shared slash command in .claude/commands/ and invoke that command from the CI job.

C. Add a CLAUDE.md instruction telling Claude Code not to ask follow-up questions during CI reviews.

D. Run Claude Code with the -p (--print) flag and provide the review prompt non-interactively.

Simulate it live

```
# In the browser: open Simulator 5, then Lab 37
cd labs
uv run serve.py

# In Claude Code, from the labs folder
/lab 37

# In a terminal, from simulators/simulator-5-ci-cd/
uv run casekit.py --case UC-38
```

What you should see

/pr-check runs unattended only because the job calls it through claude -p.

The team's /pr-check command runs non-interactively only because the job invokes it through claude -p; the command file alone does not change the execution mode.

Open `simulators/simulator-5-ci-cd/evidence/` and find it yourself.

The answer

D. -p with the review prompt supplied non-interactively.

Claude Code has an interactive terminal mode for developer sessions and a non-interactive mode for automation. -p runs the prompt, prints the result and exits, with no terminal user needed. (The same idea as Q18; the exam guide's Task 3.6 lists exactly this: run Claude Code in CI with -p to prevent interactive input hangs.)

Why the others fail

A. Plan mode adds an approval step and is still interactive. “Auto-approving” it does not remove the waiting.

B. A slash command packages the prompt but does not change the execution mode.

C. Instructions do not change how the CLI runs; it still waits on an interactive session.

Check yourself

- the slash command executed under -p and returned
- the envelope carries a session id and exit was clean

- learner can state that plan mode, a command file or a CLAUDE.md note cannot stop an interactive session from waiting

Now change one thing

Fix the loop in repo/stock/totals.py and the caller in repo/stock/jobs.py, rerun, and watch the blocking count fall.

Third-party practice material from SkillCertPro, reconstructed from a video transcript in the Tertiary Markdown Vault. Not a real exam item. Wording may differ from the original.